

## Defender Advanced Hunting — Table & Field Quick Reference

| Investigation Focus                     | Table                       | Key Fields                                                                                         | What It Tells You                                                                                                                                                         |
|-----------------------------------------|-----------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Authentication / logons                 | <b>DeviceLogonEvents</b>    | AccountName, RemoteIP, ActionType, LogonType, DeviceName                                           | Who logged on, from where, success vs. failure, and whether it was interactive, network (LogonType 3), or RDP                                                             |
| Process execution                       | <b>DeviceProcessEvents</b>  | ProcessCommandLine, FileName, InitiatingProcessFileName, InitiatingProcessCommandLine, AccountName | What actually ran, the full command line, and — via the InitiatingProcess* fields — the parent that launched it                                                           |
| Network connections / C2                | <b>DeviceNetworkEvents</b>  | RemoteUrl, RemoteIP, RemotePort, InitiatingProcessFileName, InitiatingProcessAccountName           | Outbound beacons, C2 domains/IPs, and which process/account is making the connection                                                                                      |
| File drops / staging                    | <b>DeviceFileEvents</b>     | FileName, FolderPath, SHA256, InitiatingProcessFileName, ActionType                                | What landed on disk, its hash (for blocking/threat-intel lookups), and whether it was written locally vs. over the network (kernel/ntoskrnl.exe as initiator = SMB write) |
| Registry persistence                    | <b>DeviceRegistryEvents</b> | RegistryKey, RegistryValueName, RegistryValueData, ActionType                                      | Autostart entries — mainly ...\\CurrentVersion\\Run — and what binary they point back to                                                                                  |
| Scheduled-task / service persistence    | <b>DeviceProcessEvents</b>  | ProcessCommandLine (look for schtasks.exe /create /tn ... or sc.exe create ...)                    | Task/service names created for persistence and the binPath/action pointing at the implant                                                                                 |
| Account creation / privilege escalation | <b>DeviceProcessEvents</b>  | ProcessCommandLine (look for net user ... /add and net localgroup administrators ... /add)         | New local accounts and any privilege escalation into Administrators, usually seconds apart                                                                                |

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|------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| DLL/image loads              | <b>DeviceImageLoadEvents</b>                                 | FileName, FolderPath, InitiatingProcessFileName           | Suspicious libraries loaded into a legitimate process — useful for DLL sideloading or injection cases                                  |
| Multi-host scoping           | <b>AlertEvidence</b>                                         | DeviceName, AlertId, EvidenceRole, Timestamp              | Which other devices show up in alerts tied to this incident, and what role each played (attacker-controlled vs. impacted)              |
| Device metadata              | <b>DeviceInfo</b>                                            | DeviceName, OnboardingStatus, DeviceType, OSPlatform      | Confirms a candidate host is real and onboarded, plus its role (workstation/server) and OS — good sanity check before you chase a lead |
| Cloud identity sign-ins      | <b>IdentityLogonEvents (or Entra SigninLogs in Sentinel)</b> | AccountUpon, IPAddress, ResultType, Location, Application | Azure AD/Entra sign-ins — impossible-travel patterns, MFA bypass, legacy auth abuse                                                    |
| Email / phishing entry point | <b>EmailEvents, EmailAttachmentInfo, EmailUrlInfo</b>        | SenderFromAddress, Subject, AttachmentName, Url           | Traces an initial-access phishing email, its attachment, or a malicious link back to the mailbox that received it                      |

**How to use this table when you're stuck:** start from what you already know (a device name, an account, a time window), then pick the row that matches what you're trying to find next — a logon anomaly points you to DeviceLogonEvents, a "how did it get here" question points you to DeviceFileEvents, and "did this spread" points you to AlertEvidence.